

CakePHP: How to Create a Component

Here's a hands-on tutorial on creating a component in CakePHP—a must-read for those who like to learn through practical knowledge.



CakePHP is a free and open source PHP framework. Built with MVC (model-view-controller) pattern, it provides a powerful structure for the creation of well-organised Web applications.

There are many MVC frameworks available like CakePHP, Zend, Laravel, Yii, Codeigniter, etc. CakePHP is one of the top MVC frameworks. It is suitable for small, medium and large scale applications, and provides most of the tools we need to build an application. Instead of building from scratch, just copy CakePHP and start building your application. CakePHP has a very active development team and a large community for help. Its key features are inbuilt CRUD operations, automatic code generation, inbuilt validations, ACL, caching, etc.

In this tutorial, we will learn the basic concept of a component, how to create our own components and use them in our application. We will use the CakePHP 2.x version.

A CakePHP component

A component is a class file which contains the common

code or logic. The component can be shared between the application's controllers. CakePHP comes with some good components, so you can perform various common tasks like session handling, cookies and security related things, etc.

A component is a good option when you need the same logic or functions in multiple controllers. It helps you to reuse the code and make your controllers tiny and clean. Apart from the built-in components of CakePHP, you can create your own components for common functionality such as handling file uploads, image processing or any common logic of our application.

Creating a component

Creating a component is a simple task. Just like a normal PHP class, you need to create a class file in your *Component* directory. The name of the class must be in *CamelCase* format and the word *Component* must be appended to it. For example, if you want to create a password component, the class name will be *PasswordComponent* and the file name will be *PasswordComponent.php*.